

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

DJIA 40669.36 ▲ 141.74 0.35%

NASDAQ 17446.34 ▼ 0.1%

STOXX 600 527.48 ▲ 0.5%

10-YR. TREAS. ▼ 1/32, yield 4.173%

OIL \$58.21 ▼ \$2.21

GOLD \$3,305.00 ▼ \$13.80

EURO \$1.1332

YEN 143.06

What's News

Business & Finance

- ◆ **The U.S. economy** contracted in the first three months of 2025, as businesses rushed to stock up on imports ahead of the Trump administration's tariffs and consumer spending slowed. **A1**
- ◆ **The S&P 500 and Dow** rose 0.1% and 0.3%, respectively, to end a tumultuous month with a seventh straight session gain, while the Nasdaq fell less than 0.1%. **B1**
- ◆ **China's economy** showed its first big signs of damage from the trade war with the U.S., with a steep drop in export orders in April and the weakest factory production in more than a year. **A1**
- ◆ **Meta Platforms** said its sales reached \$42 billion in the first quarter and indicated that growth would remain steady in the coming months. **B1**
- ◆ **Meta launched** a stand-alone artificial-intelligence app that is accessible across its social-media platforms. **B4**
- ◆ **Microsoft** posted strong growth in revenue and earnings for its fiscal third quarter, with its cloud business solidly beating Wall Street's forecasts. **B1**
- ◆ **Google's CEO** urged a judge to reject the "extraordinary" measures proposed by the Justice Department to curtail the company's dominance in online search. **B1**
- ◆ **A federal judge** hammered Apple for violating an antitrust ruling related to App Store restrictions, referring the matter to prosecutors for a criminal contempt investigation. **B2**
- ◆ **Paramount Global** and Trump began mediation talks in connection with the president's suit against the company's CBS News division. **B4**

World-Wide

- ◆ **The Trump administration** reached a deal with Ukraine giving the U.S. access to its mineral wealth, overcoming last-minute haggling that had held up an agreement. **A1**
- ◆ **The Supreme Court** heard arguments over the permissibility of religious charter schools in an Oklahoma case that represents one of the biggest contests between church and state in a generation. **A2**
- ◆ **An attempt to reject** Trump's worldwide "Liberation Day" tariffs fell short in the Senate, as most Republicans stayed aligned with the White House. **A4**
- ◆ **A federal judge** in Vermont ordered the government to release Mohsen Mahdawi while his case proceeds, saying the administration was threatening to deport legal residents for stating their political views. **A3**
- ◆ **House Republicans** are seriously considering proposals to further limit tax deductions that companies can take for their highest-paid workers' compensation. **A6**
- ◆ **A bipartisan group** of legislators reintroduced a bill to stimulate demand for hundreds of U.S.-built ships and provide tax incentives for shipyard improvements. **A4**
- ◆ **Trump ally Sen. Lindsey Graham** is forging ahead with a plan to impose new sanctions on Russia and steep tariffs on countries that buy Russian oil, gas and uranium. **A8**
- ◆ **Trump pressed Egypt** to compensate the U.S. for its efforts to defend shipping lanes that service the Suez Canal, putting Cairo in a bind. **A20**

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Economy Shrinks as Tariffs Take Toll

GDP declines 0.3% on rush to snap up imports as spending by consumers slows

By HARRIET TORRY

The U.S. economy contracted in the first three months of 2025, as businesses rushed to stock up on imports ahead of the Trump administration's tariffs and consumer spending slowed.

The Commerce Department said gross domestic product—the value of all goods and ser-

vices produced across the U.S. economy—fell at a seasonally and inflation adjusted 0.3% annual rate in the first quarter. That was the first contraction since the first three months of 2022.

Consumer spending, the economy's main engine, rose at a 1.8% pace in the first quarter, the smallest increase since mid-2023. Spending by the federal government fell as the Department of Government Efficiency cut jobs and contracts.

But the main driver of the first-quarter contraction was President Trump's trade war. Net exports, the difference be-

tween what the U.S. imports and exports, subtracted nearly five percentage points from headline GDP. That was the biggest quarterly drag from net exports on record dating back to 1947.

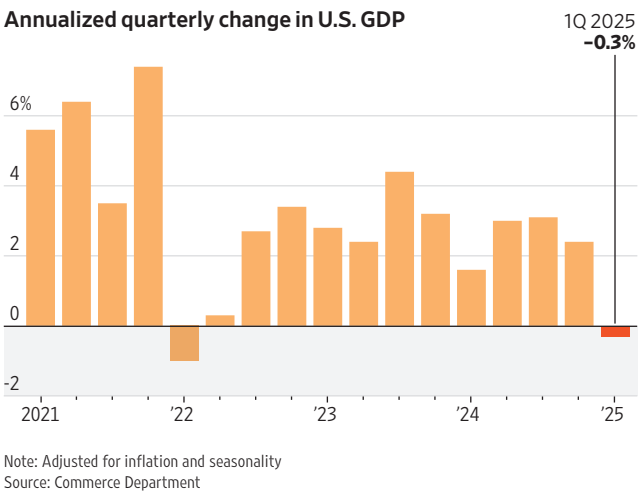
Imports subtract from the Commerce Department's calculation of GDP because they represent spending on foreign-made goods and services.

"The headline decline over-

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◆ **Senate bid to repeal Trump tariffs fails..... A4**

◆ **Making an all-U.S. product proves difficult..... B1**



Vietnam Celebrates 50 Years Since End of War



HISTORY MARCHES ON: Female soldiers took part in a Ho Chi Minh City parade Wednesday to mark the 50th anniversary of the end of the Vietnam War. The country's new role as a top exporter of clothes to the U.S. is threatened by the Trump tariffs. **A12, A20**

Ukraine and U.S. Sign Deal On Access to Rare Minerals

By JANE LYTUVYENKO AND ALAN CULLISON

The Trump administration reached a deal on Wednesday with Ukraine giving the U.S. access to its mineral wealth, overcoming last-minute haggling that had held up an agreement that President Trump had sought to compensate the U.S. for helping Ukraine fight off Russia's invasion.

Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent hailed the deal as a

step toward a negotiated end to the war in Ukraine and a beginning of the country's reconstruction. In tightly controlled negotiations, the Trump administration dropped its insistence that the agreement allow Washington to recoup billions of dollars of past military aid.

"As the President has said, the United States is committed to helping facilitate the end of this cruel and senseless war," Bessent said in a statement. "This agreement signals clearly

to Russia that the Trump Administration is committed to a peace process centered on a free, sovereign, and prosperous Ukraine over the long term."

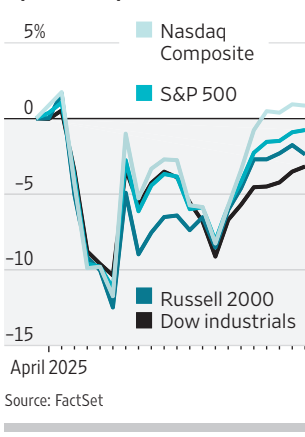
The agreement marks an improvement for relations between Kyiv and Washington, which have soured in recent months, not least over the deal for Ukraine's minerals. A one-

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◆ **Graham builds support for Russia sanctions..... A8**

Volatile April Comes to End

Stocks stage a late rally to end month on high note. **B1**



Junior Bankers at Boutique Firm Pushed to Brink by 110-Hour Weeks

By BEN GLICKMAN AND ALEXANDER SAEEDY

A team of junior bankers had been regularly working until 4 a.m. for weeks when they were called together for a pizza party last year.

Some of the young analysts and associates assumed it was a reward for their work pitching and closing deals on the industrials team at Robert W.

Baird, a Midwestern bank founded more than a century ago. Instead, the managers who organized the gathering in Chicago told the group they needed to step up their performance, according to multiple people familiar with the meeting.

Some bankers objected, noting the long hours they were working. Managers replied that they should be

working more efficiently, the people familiar with the matter said.

Wall Street has been reckoning with its culture of long hours and failure of workplace guardrails since the death of two young bankers in the past year. Many junior bankers have said that their complaints are ignored and that senior bankers routinely break

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For U.S.'s Only Metric Highway, This May Be the End of the Road

Kilometer signs that mark Arizona stretch come under review in 'America First' push

By ELIZA COLLINS

34 KM FROM NOGALES, Ariz.—The highway that runs from Tucson, Ariz. to Mexico is about 63 miles long, but that fact won't do you any good.

That's because I-19 is the only American highway that fully measures distance in kilometers, a relic of a failed ef-

fort in the 1970s for the U.S. to adopt the metric system. Some 50 years later, the kilometer countdown remains.

President Trump was elected for a second term with a promise to put America's interests first. In his first day back in the White House, Trump changed the name of

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INSIDE



BUSINESS & FINANCE
Berkshire Hathaway's 'Woodstock for Capitalists' draws global admirers. **B1**

Nobody Feels Office Pain More Than This Guy

Shorenstein scion took over property empire at time of maximum upheaval

By PETER GRANT

Brandon Shorenstein became one of the biggest owners of office buildings under the worst circumstances imaginable.

He was thrust into the top job of his family's real-estate company at the age of 34, just as Covid-19 was sending the U.S. office market into its biggest tailspin since World War II. His father's death from cancer forced him to find his place among the older, more battle-hardened leadership of Shorenstein Properties, the company his grandfather founded.

Early on in the pandemic, the company, based in San Francisco, was one of the few big office owners to keep buying properties—but that strategy now looks pre-

mature. Much of the office market today is still badly struggling, dragging down thousands of landlords.

More recently, brokers report that businesses are putting space searches on hold while concerns build about a trade war and possible recession. At the start of this year, Shorenstein cut its staff by close to 10%, the company's largest-ever lay-off.

"I'm getting my ass kicked every day," Shorenstein told another real-estate executive who bumped into him at an industry event last year, the executive recalled.

The downsizing has been necessary partly because Shorenstein has sold numerous properties for less than their purchase prices. For example, in late 2023 the

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